A-A-50854
October 15, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING, WITH TRANSPORT MEDIA

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-T-36815D.

This commercial item description covers a sterile, biological culture sampling tube, suitable for collecting and holding biological cultures moist and viable for 72 hours.

Salient characteristics:

Shall be an assembled sterile biological culture sampling tube suitable for collecting and holding biological cultures, such as pseudomonas aeruginosa ATCC No. 15442 and Group a Streptococcus ATCC No. 7958, moist and viable for 72 hours.

As a minimum, shall consist of a plastic tube, snug-fitting closure cap, applicator swab, and transport media. Shall be supplied sealed in a peel-open type envelope suitable for maintaining sterility until manually opened. The envelope shall not be resealable after opening.

The transport media shall be Modified Stuarts media or Amies media without charcoal. The Modified Stuarts transport media shall be supplied in a crushable glass ampule and located in the distal portion of the tube below an absorbent fabric plug that separates the ampule from the applicator swab. The Amies transport media shall be contained in a sealed chamber located at the distal portion of the tube.

The volume of transport media shall be sufficient to cover and moisten all surfaces of the swab tip, and keep any collected live cultures located on any sector (surface) of the swab tip viable for 72 hours. The method of moistening the swab tip shall be included in the manufacturer's instructions. When the swab tip is moistened, by following manufacturer's instructions, the released transport media shall completely cover and completely moisten the swab tip without exhibiting the following:

1. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper portion of the swab stick (i.e. upper half of the exposed length).

2. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper half of the inside surfaces of the tube.

The design of the biological culture sampling tube shall be such that excess or aqueous type transport media that is released in accordance with manufacturer's instructions, shall be controlled so that there is no coating or splattering of transport media on the outside of the tube.

The applicator stick shall be wood or plastic and cylindrical in shape with nominal dimensions (inches) of 3/32 diameter x 6 long. The distal end of the stick shall be covered with swab tip made of cotton, rayon, or polyester. A suitable adhesive shall be used to secure the swab tip to the stick.

The tube shall be fabricated of transparent or translucent semi-rigid plastic. The distal end shall be closed to preclude leakage of transport media. The opposite end shall be open, and shall be supplied with a snug-fitting and readily removable closure cap.

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The method and efficacy of sterilization of the biological tube and inside surfaces of the envelope shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

Not less than 16 months of the expiration dating period shall remain at time of delivery to the Government.

Workmanship. The biological culture tube and envelope shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred individually packaged tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same as the product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-00-518-5462

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

55660

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6640-1157

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